October 2026

VMware vDefend Lateral Security & Advanced Threat Prevention 9.x Administrator

Exam Details (Last Updated: 10/30/2026)

The VMware vDefend Lateral Security & Advanced Threat Prevention 9.x Administrator exam (6V0-23.26), which leads to the VMware Certified Professional - Private Cloud Security Administrator (VCP-PCS Admin) certification, is a 75-item exam with a passing score of 70%, using a scaled method. The exam time is 90 minutes.

Exam Delivery

This is a proctored exam delivered through Pearson VUE. For more information, visit the Pearson VUE website.

Certification information

For details and a complete list of requirements and recommendations for attainment, please reference the Certification website.

Minimally Qualified Candidate

The Minimally Qualified Candidate has experience securing a VMware Cloud Foundation private cloud using distributed and gateway firewalls, advanced threat prevention, and security intelligence to enable zero-trust architectures with VMware vDefend.

Exam Section

The following table lists the Certification exam objectives for the exam and how these objectives align to the corresponding course topics and their associated lab exercises as well as the referenced product documentation.

Exam Objectives	Content	Exam Focus
01 Understanding Modern Private Cloud Data Center Security	Tests knowledge of securing a private cloud environment.	2%
02 Understanding the Threat Landscape	Tests knowledge of common attack vectors, ransomware trends, and lateral movement techniques that threaten private cloud data centers.	3%
03 Understanding VMware vDefend Firewall Architecture	Tests knowledge of software-defined, distributed security architecture.	4%
04 Implementing VMware vDefend Licensing	Tests knowledge of vDefend Firewall licensing editions, entitlements, and the per-core licensing model.	4%
05 Managing the VMware vDefend Distributed Firewall	Tests knowledge of configuring and managing the distributed firewall settings.	6%

06 Configuring Lateral Protection with vDefend Distributed Firewall	Tests knowledge of implementing and managing policy-based rules for controlling traffic across the private cloud.	11%
07 Deploying VMware vDefend Security Services Platform (SSP)	Tests knowledge of the back-end security data and analytics platform.	6%
08 Planning Application Segmentation with vDefend Security Intelligence	Tests knowledge of a distributed analytics engine that develops micro-segmentation policies by analyzing workload and network context.	9%
09 Securing the VCF Management Domain with VMware vDefend	Tests knowledge of managing a software-defined, distributed firewall solution for securing virtualized workloads within private clouds	3%
10 Implementing Context Aware Firewall and Identity Firewall	Tests knowledge of advanced security solutions that go beyond traditional firewall rules based on IP addresses and ports, offering more granular control and security by considering user identity, application context, and other factors.	7%
11 Gateway Firewall	Tests knowledge of security devices that sit at the edge of a network, acting as a gatekeeper to control and filter network traffic, ensuring only legitimate and secure data packets pass through while blocking unauthorized access and potential threats.	4%
12 Implementing VMware vDefend Bare Metal Agents	Tests knowledge of deploying the vDefend Firewall agent on bare metal servers to extend distributed firewall protection beyond virtual machines.	4%
13 Protecting Container Workloads with vDefend Firewall	Tests knowledge of securing container workloads by providing granular, context-based security enforcement at scale, enabling zero-trust principles and protecting against lateral movement of threats.	5%
14 Implementing VMware vDefend IDPS (Intrusion Detection and Prevention System)	Tests knowledge of how to inspect network traffic at every hypervisor and workload to detect and prevent advanced cyber threats.	7%
15 Implementing VMware vDefend Malware Prevention	Tests knowledge of private cloud workload safeguards against ransomware and malicious activity.	5%
16 Implementing VMware vDefend Network Traffic Analysis (NTA)	Tests knowledge of proactive threat detection and response leveraging both NTA and NDR capabilities to secure virtualized workloads and environments.	3%
17 Implementing VMware vDefend Network Detection & Response (NDR)	Tests knowledge of correlating signals from IDPS, malware prevention, and network traffic analysis to detect and respond to advanced threat campaigns.	2%
18 Implementing Security Automation and Orchestration	Tests knowledge of integrating tools and scripting languages to automate firewall policy creation, security group management, and network configuration.	3%
19 Troubleshooting Security	Tests knowledge of managing and operating security in the private cloud.	3%
20 Implementing VMware vDefend for Federated Environments	Tests knowledge of extending vDefend security policies across multiple sites using NSX Federation and Global Manager.	4%
21 Introduction to Private Cloud Security	Tests knowledge of foundational private cloud security concepts and the role of software-defined security in the data center.	1%

22 Private Cloud Security	Tests knowledge of security challenges and best practices unique to private cloud data center environments.	1%
23 The Common Threat DNA	Tests knowledge of a suite of analysis tools designed to defend against advanced threats that use known and unknown attack vectors.	1%
24 Today's Threat Landscape	Tests knowledge of current cyberattack trends and techniques, including ransomware and advanced persistent threats, affecting private clouds.	2%

Recommended Courses

VMware vDefend Lateral Security & Advanced Threat Prevention 9.x Training

References

In addition to the recommended course, item writers recommend the following resources for you to reference content as you prepare to take the exam, in addition to the recommended training.

https://www.vmware.com/docs/beginners-guide-to-automation-with-vdefend-firewall

https://www.vmware.com/docs/vmware-advanced-threat-prevention-with-nsx-distributed-firewall

https://www.vmware.com/docs/vmware-nsx-ndr-so

https://www.vmware.com/docs/vmware-nsx-distributed-ids-ips-solution-overview

https://techdocs.broadcom.com/us/en/vmware-security-load-balancing/vdefend/security-services-platform/5-2/security-services-platform-overview.html

https://techdocs.broadcom.com/us/en/vmware-security-load-balancing/vdefend/vdefend-firewall/9-1.html

Sample Questions

Sample Question 1

Which attribute is fundamental to a Modern Private Cloud for ensuring consistent management and abstraction of compute, storage, and networking from underlying physical hardware?

A. Workload agnosticism
B. Location agnosticism
C. Software-defined infrastructure
D. Self-service and automation

Answer: C

Sample Question 2

What is a core capability of the Distributed Firewall in VMware vDefend?

A. Managing physical network switches
B. Providing visibility and control for virtualized workloads
C. Configuring hardware-based firewalls
D. Enforcing policies on bare-metal servers only

Answer: B

Sample Question 3

When using the vDefend Gateway Firewall to protect the virtual infrastructure, what is a critical design consideration regarding connectivity between the NSX Manager and the edge nodes hosting the gateway firewall?

A. They must be isolated on separate networks with a firewall between them for maximum security.
B. They should be on the same network with no firewall between them to ensure proper connectivity.
C. Connectivity between them is not a concern as the Gateway Firewall operates independently.
D. The vDefend Manager should always be deployed on a bare metal server, separate from the edge nodes.

Answer: B

Sample Question 4

What is the maximum file size that VMware vDefend Malware Prevention Service will analyze for a single file?

A. 64 MB
B. 100 MB
C. 256 MB
D. 10 MB

Answer: A

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